

SUHA KIM

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FIELDS OF INTERESTS

Decision Theory, Behavioral Economics, Experimental Economics

EDUCATION

The Ohio State University

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics

(Chair: Prof. John Rehbeck)

Apr 2024 - *Current*

Columbus,

OH, United States

The Ohio State University, M.A. in Economics

Aug 2022

Columbus,

OH, United States

Sogang University, B.A. in Economics with Honors,

B.S. in Mathematics

Magna Cum Laude, Honors in Economic Theory

Feb 2019

Seoul, South Korea

The Pennsylvania State University

Undergraduate Exchange Student

Dean's List

Aug 2016 - Dec 2016

State College,

PA, United States

AWARDS AND GRANTS

OHIO STATE U.

Larry and Shelia Kantor Award and Prize

2026

Decision Science Collaborative Research Grant

2025

Department of Economics Fellowships

2021-22

SOGANG U.

Award for Devotion, Center for Teaching and Learning

2020

- Recognizing the service for the education of the school community after COVID-19 outbreak

Dean's List Award, Department of Economics

2018S, 2015S

Sogang Research Grant for Undergraduate Students

2017

Mirae Asset Study Abroad Scholarships (7,000,000 KRW)

2016

Academic Excellence Scholarships for Freshmen

2014-2015

PUBLISHED WORKS

“Reciprocal preferences and expectations in International agreements”

with Doruk İriş, *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, Oct 2025, Vol. 238: 107243

Abstract This paper investigates the impact of reciprocal preferences and countries’ fairness-based expectations of each other in the context of international agreements aimed at providing global public goods. Reciprocal countries reward kindness (positive reciprocity) while retaliating against unkind behavior (negative reciprocity). We introduce a model where countries decide not only whether to participate on a coalition but also determine the extent of their effort. We demonstrate that reciprocal preferences can exert both positive and negative effects on the effort of both signatories and non-signatories of a treaty, depending on their expectations of others. In the non-cooperative game, there are three possible Nash equilibria, which depend on the degree of reciprocal concerns and expectations: no contribution, full contribution by all, and an interior solution. In the coalition formation game, if countries have limited yet sufficiently strong reciprocal concerns and low expectations, the grand coalition – where all countries sign the treaty (and exert efficient effort levels) – becomes stable. Interestingly, we find that signatories positively influence non-signatories’ efforts. Anticipating this response, signatories have an additional strategic incentive to increase their efforts, thereby enhancing the overall level of cooperation.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

“Asking Right Questions: A More Direct Test of Rational Inattention Models”

with Hyeonngyun Ko, Jason Tayawa

Abstract We design a laboratory experiment to evaluate the empirical validity of rational inattention models by employing two different frames: direct (choosing posterior beliefs) and natural (choosing sampling size) frames. The direct frame is closely aligned with the primitives of rational inattention models, whereas the natural frame more closely resembles the choice environments commonly implemented in laboratory settings. By observing information acquisition in both frames, we assess which class of rational inattention models better accounts for behavior, beyond what can be inferred from action choices alone.

The experimental results indicate that subjects frequently exhibit information acquisition patterns that are not fully consistent with either model class, thereby rejecting the empirical equivalence of the two frames. At the aggregate level, behavior differs systematically across frames, as if subjects faced a distinct class of information cost structures in each environment. At the individual level, a substantial share of subjects switch in the model class that best rationalizes their behavior across frames. This finding is notable because the two classes identified, Uniform Posterior Separable (UPS) and Prior Invariant (PI), are generically theoretically disjoint, intersecting only in the degenerate case of zero information costs. These results call into question the common assumption that experimental designs may employ indirect but natural decision variables without loss of generality when testing models defined over posterior distributions.

“Distinguishing different forms of complexity: Math and Correlation Neglect”

with John Rehbeck

Abstract The complexity of a decision problem arises from various factors. We define and distinguish the factors of complexity: “Computational complexity,” “Implementation complexity,” and “Contextual complexity.” We design very simple experiment to distinguish the forms of complexity. We document behaviors in the context of Correlation Neglect (Enke and Zimmermann, 2019), a construct frequently used in experiments to assess the problem’s complexity relative to the ability to identify and understand correlations. Based on the results of lab experiments, we suggest examining the different attributes of complexity across different experimental designs.

“Flex or Commit? Randomization Revealed by Menu Choice”

Abstract Individuals may not be certain about their own preferences, leading to a preference for a flexible menu. At the same time, when an option combined with recommendations is tempting, people often prefer to commit to the smaller menu. Focusing on the condition in which these two forces occur simultaneously, I conduct an experiment to document the correlation between an individual’s ex-ante menu preference and the ex-post random choice. More specifically, the experiment tests the extent to which ex-post randomized choices are driven by a preference for flexibility or for commitment. From the experiment, we also verify whether the two driving forces can coexist and be reflected together in the ex-post choice.

PRE-DOCTORAL EXPERIENCES

Research Assistant for Young-Chul Kim (Sogang U.), Glenn Loury (Brown U.) 2019-2020
· On “Social Network Externalities and the Dynamics of Group Inequality”

CONFERENCE/WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS

2026

Midwest Theory Conference, EER Summer School 2026 (Scheduled), M-BEES 2026 in Maas-tricht (Scheduled), EEA-ESEM (Econometric Society European Meeting) 2026 (Scheduled)

2025

BEEMA at Lehigh U, Midwest Experimental Economics Meeting for Graduate Students (MEEM-GS) at Indiana U, ESA North America Meeting at Tucson

2024

ESA North America Meeting at OSU

2023

ESA North America Meeting at UNC Charlotte

2021

European Association of Environmental and Resource Economics (EAERE) 26th Annual Con-ference, WEAI Virtual 96th Annual Conference, ESA North America Meeting at Tucson

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

Independent Instructor,

Principles of Microeconomics, 2026SU, 2025SU

Recitation Leader,

Microeconomics 1A (PhD-level course), 2025F, 2024F, 2023F
Principles of Microeconomics, 2024S, 2023S

Grader,

Intermediate Microeconomics, Principles of Microeconomics, Economic Issues in US 2026S,
2022F, 2022S

Teaching Assistant for Prof. Yong Sakong, Sogang University 2019-2020
- Economic Statistics; Agricultural Economics; Markets for Derivatives

Head Tutor, Economics Study Center, Sogang University 2019-2020

SERVICES

‘Graduate Women in Economics,’ Ohio State University 2024-2026
President (2024-25), Vice President (2025-26)
Organizer, ‘GWE Annaul Research & Networking Forum’ (2024-25)
(Advisor: Prof. Meta Brown)

‘Corner Solution,’ Undergraduate Economics Reading Group, Sogang University 2016-2018
(Advisor: Prof. Jungsoo Park)

PROGRAMMING SKILLS

- Mathematica, MATLAB, / - STATA, SAS, EViews, / - z-Tree, o-Tree / - $\text{\LaTeX}$

LANGUAGES

- English (Fluent), Korean (Native)

REFERENCES

John Rehbeck

Associate Professor

Ohio State University

Department of Economics

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